

Doc Id: MD-IT-008

Title: Security Incident Reporting Policy

Version: "1.0"

Effective Date: 2026-07-01

Owner Team: IT Security

Applies To: Everyone with access to Meridian Dynamics devices, accounts, data, or facilities

Review Cadence: Semiannual

MD-IT-008 - Security Incident Reporting Policy

1. Purpose

This policy tells employees and contractors how to report suspected phishing, credential disclosure, malware, lost devices, unauthorized access, data exposure, and other security concerns. Early reporting is required even when the reporter is uncertain or believes they made a mistake. Common tickets include I clicked a phishing link, I entered my password, unexpected MFA prompt, laptop was stolen, and a file was shared with the wrong person. The policy prioritizes personal safety, containment, evidence preservation, and rapid IT Security ownership. Reporting in good faith is encouraged and must not be delayed while the employee investigates alone.

2. Scope

The policy applies to Meridian identities, managed and personal devices used for company access, email and collaboration, business applications, physical media, customer or company data, and suspicious activity observed at any location. It covers suspected events; proof is not required before reporting. Routine spam with no interaction may be reported through the approved message-report control, while any click, attachment opening, credential entry, approval prompt, or reply requires a support incident. Ordinary password lockout follows MD-IT-003 only when no suspicious signal exists. Hardware failure follows MD-IT-005 unless loss, theft, tampering, or safety is involved. Employees must not contact a suspected attacker, affected external person, or law enforcement on the company's behalf unless directed.

3. Definitions

A security incident is suspected or confirmed activity that could harm confidentiality, integrity, availability, identity, or physical device control. Phishing is a deceptive message, call, or page intended to obtain credentials, approval, money, or data. Credential disclosure occurs when a password, recovery code, token, or MFA approval is provided to an untrusted party. Active compromise means unauthorized access is observed or strongly confirmed and may still be occurring. Data exposure means company or customer information reached an unauthorized person or location. Evidence preservation means keeping the message, timestamp, device state, address, and error without altering or publicly sharing them. Employees may say hacked, clicked a bad link, sent to wrong person, virus pop-up, or phone stolen.

4. Policy / Procedure

1. If there is physical danger, smoke, or threat, move to safety first and use local emergency procedures. Otherwise stop interacting with the suspicious message, page, device, or person.
2. Report immediately through the security incident channel or Service Desk. Include the time, device, account, what was clicked or entered, observed prompts, data involved, and current device location. State plainly if a password was entered or an MFA prompt approved.
3. Preserve evidence. Do not delete the message, wipe the device, forward the content externally, run unapproved cleanup tools, or continue testing a link. Disconnect a managed device from networks only when instructed or when obviously active malicious control is occurring; keep it powered on unless safety requires otherwise.
4. IT Security validates scope, contains sessions or devices, resets credentials through controlled procedures, and coordinates notifications. Service Desk does not independently promise that an incident is resolved.
5. Continue reporting new prompts or activity and follow the incident lead s instructions. Business communications to customers or outside parties are made only by authorized Meridian Dynamics representatives.

5. Priority & escalation

IT Security owns every security_incident. Confirmed active compromise, confirmed data exposure, dangerous device behavior, or unauthorized access to a critical service is critical urgency and P1 with immediate paging. Suspected phishing interaction, a clicked link, opened attachment, disclosed password, unexpected MFA approval, stolen managed device, or suspected exposure without confirmed access is high urgency and P2 with a fifteen-minute initial response. An unclicked suspicious message reported through the approved control is medium urgency, normally P3, unless a campaign affects 10 or more users, in which case it escalates to P1 or P2 based on interaction and impact. General security questions with no event are low urgency and may begin with Service Desk. The reporter s uncertainty never justifies downgrading observable risk; MD-IT-002 governs reassessment.

6. Related documents

MD-IT-002 defines the general impact and urgency matrix. MD-IT-003 governs controlled password reset after IT Security contains a suspected account. MD-IT-004 governs factor replacement after device loss or unexpected prompts. MD-IT-005 governs safe handling and replacement after a device incident. MD-IT-007 describes the boundary between collaboration troubleshooting and phishing. MD-IT-009 covers urgent access revocation, and MD-IT-010 covers remote privacy and suspicious network warnings.

7. Revision history

Version 1.0 became effective on 2026-07-01. It establishes immediate good-faith reporting, explicit phishing and credential-disclosure examples, evidence-preservation rules, fifteen-minute P2 response, confirmed-compromise P1 handling, and exclusive IT Security ownership of incident containment.